



Introduction to LeetCode and HackerRank

Section 1: What Are LeetCode and HackerRank?

1.1 What is LeetCode?

LeetCode is an online platform that helps users practice coding through **algorithmic problems**. It is very popular among students preparing for **tech interviews**.

Key Features:

- Thousands of coding problems sorted by **difficulty and topic**
- **Contest section** for real-time coding competitions
- **Company-specific questions** (like Google, Amazon, Infosys)
- Built-in **online editor** for more than 14 programming languages

Website: <https://leetcode.com>

1.2 What is HackerRank?

HackerRank is also a coding practice platform but with a strong focus on **real-world challenges**, including domains like **SQL, Data Structures, Artificial Intelligence, and Databases**.

Key Features:

- **Coding challenges** across multiple domains
- **Certifications** in Python, Java, SQL, etc.
- Practice **mock interviews** and **30 Days of Code** challenge

Website: <https://www.hackerrank.com>



Section 2: Why Should You Use Them?

Let's Ask Ourselves:

- *Do you want to improve your coding skills practically?*
- *Are you preparing for campus placements or interviews?*
- *Would you like to compare your solution with others?*
- *Do you want to earn certificates to add to your resume?*

If your answer is **yes** to even one of the above, then these platforms are **must-use tools** for you.

Section 3: Differences Between LeetCode and HackerRank

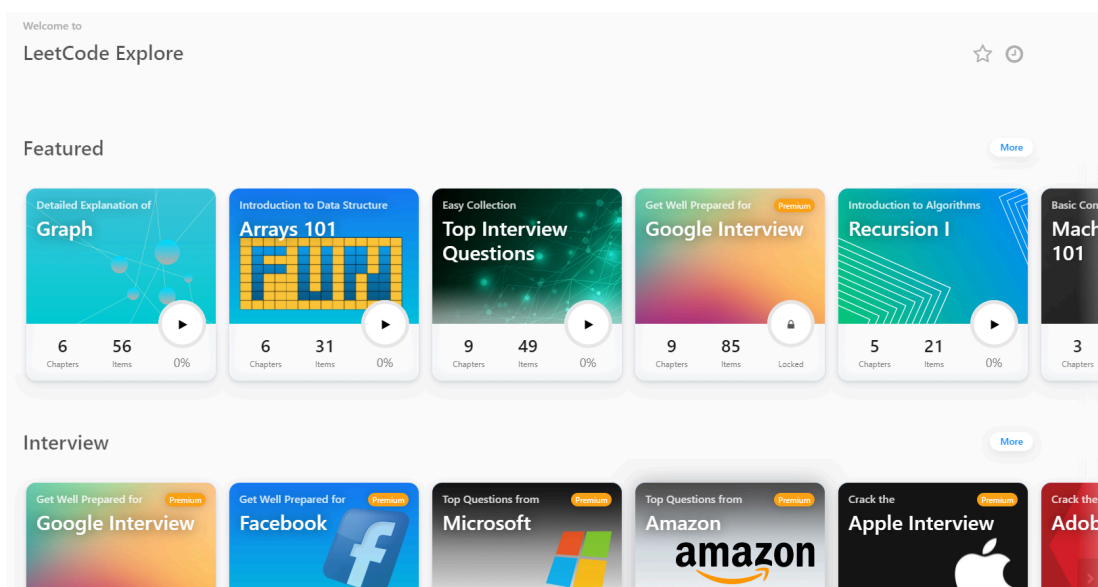
Feature	LeetCode	HackerRank
Focus Area	Interview Prep, Algorithms	Practice + Certifications
Ideal For	Advanced Prep, DSA Learners	Beginners + Language Practice
Language Support	14+ Languages	20+ Languages
UI/UX	Minimal, Interview-centric	Interactive, Game-like
Certification	No	Yes (Python, SQL, etc.)
Company Tagging	Yes	Limited



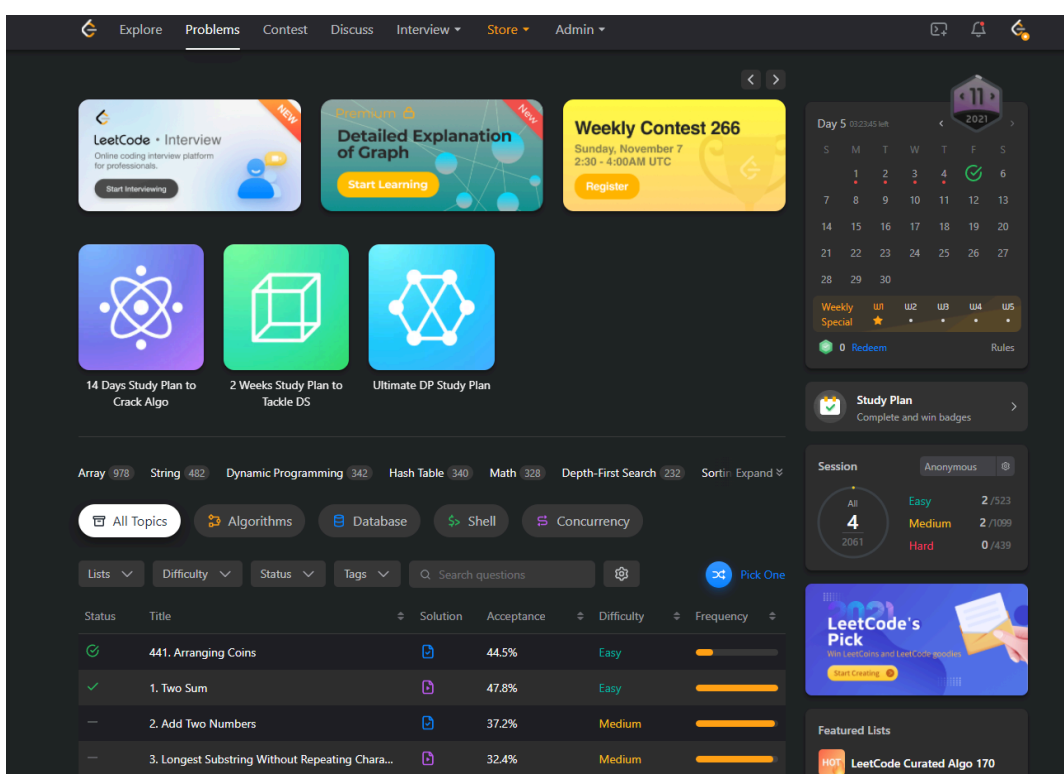
Section 4: How to Get Started

Step-by-Step to Start with LeetCode:

1. Go to leetcode.com
2. Create an account using Google or email
3. Start with the **Explore** tab and begin **Easy Problems**



4. Use **tags** to practice topic-wise (e.g., Arrays, Strings)



5. Explore the **Interview Section** once you're confident



Step-by-Step to Start with HackerRank:

1. Visit hackerrank.com
2. Sign up with Google/email
3. Start with **30 Days of Code** or **Problem Solving** track

HackerRank | Prepare | Certify | Compete | Apply

Prepare > Tutorials > 30 Days of Code

30 Days of Code

IMPROVE YOUR CODING SKILLS BY CODING FOR 30 DAYS IN A ROW

- Unlock a new code challenge and tutorial each day
- Submit solutions in Java, C++ and other popular languages
- Learn if-else statements, recursion, data structures, object-oriented programming and more

JOIN 30 DAYS OF CODE

4. Take **certification tests** in Python, SQL, or Java

Get Your Skills Certified

Angular (Basic) ⓘ Get Certified	Angular (Intermediate) ⓘ Get Certified	C# (Basic) ⓘ Get Certified
CSS (Basic) ⓘ Get Certified	Go (Intermediate) ⓘ Get Certified	Go (Basic) ⓘ Get Certified
Java (Basic) ⓘ Get Certified	JavaScript (Intermediate) ⓘ Get Certified	JavaScript (Basic) ⓘ Get Certified

5. Review **discussion section** for tips and explanations
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Section 5: Smart Tips for Beginners

- **Don't rush** to solve hard problems.
 - Focus on **one language** (Python/Java/C++) first.
 - Use the “**Discuss**” or “**Editorial**” **tab** to understand solutions.
 - Track your **progress** through badges or streaks.
 - Learn to **read test cases and debug** properly.
 - Avoid copying code; **practice makes you confident**.
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Section 6: Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs)

Q1. Which platform is better?

Both have their strengths. Use LeetCode for interview prep, and HackerRank for structured learning and certifications.

Q2. Can I get a job through these platforms?

Yes. **LeetCode contests** and **HackerRank certifications** can attract recruiters.

Q3. Is it free?

Yes, both offer **free problems**, though LeetCode has a premium version for exclusive problems.

Q4. Which programming language should I choose?

Start with **Python** if you're a beginner. It's easy to learn and widely used.

Q5. How many problems should I solve daily?

Start with **1-2 problems per day** and gradually increase. Consistency matters more than quantity.



Know More

- Join communities on **LinkedIn**, **Telegram**, or **Discord** for group learning.
 - Try to take part in **monthly contests** for boosting your speed and accuracy.
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Final Thought

Both **LeetCode** and **HackerRank** are essential tools in your **coding journey**.

Stay consistent, stay curious.